

CloseCut Product Vision & Requirements

The Foundational Product Specification - Version 1.0

Table of Contents

CloseCut

Product Vision & Requirements

The Foundational Product Specification

Version 1.0

Status: Canonical Working Baseline

Date: 13 July 2026

Owner: Azul / Blue

Classification: Internal Product Documentation

Document Status

This document establishes the first canonical product baseline for CloseCut. It replaces historical PRDs as the source of product truth, while preserving them as evidence of product evolution. It does not replace the Design System, Engineering Architecture Guide, Backend Specification, Testing Guide, or Marketing Design System; those documents must derive from and remain consistent with this specification.

Purpose

The purpose of this book is to define the product CloseCut is building, the value it must preserve, the boundaries it must not cross, the verified scope of the current beta, and the framework by which the product may evolve. It is deliberately implementation-aware but not implementation-

led. Code establishes what exists today; product principles establish what should remain true when implementation changes.

Intended Audience

Product owners and collaborators making scope or priority decisions.

Designers translating product intent into flows, components, content, and motion.

Engineers interpreting functional boundaries, privacy rules, states, and acceptance criteria.

QA and release owners defining evidence for TestFlight and App Store readiness.

Marketing and community owners making public claims about current and future capability.

Future collaborators who need a reliable mental model before reading implementation documentation.

How to Use This Document

Read Part I before proposing a major feature. Use Part II when designing or evaluating a specific product area. Use Part III as the rule set for privacy, recommendations, social behavior, language, states, and quality. Use Part IV for release planning, metrics, experiments, and governance. Appendices contain status, evidence, terminology, diagrams, decision matrices, and historical context.

Sources and Evidence Model

The evidence hierarchy is:

Current repository and build behavior - source of truth for what exists.

Current repository audits and known-limitations documentation - source of truth for identified gaps and operational assumptions.

Historical PRDs, Design Specifications, and Programming Guides - sources of intent, rationale, and product evolution.

Product decisions recorded in this specification - source of truth for canonical direction.

Long-term concepts - directional hypotheses, never current-product claims.

Every feature is assigned one of four statuses: **Implemented**, **Partial**, **Future**, or **Obsolete**.

“Implemented” means evidence exists in the repository; it does not imply production maturity.

“Partial” means meaningful capability exists but a material part of the intended trust, reliability, or lifecycle is incomplete.

Versioning and Change Control

Major versions change enduring product architecture, positioning, or governance.

Minor versions add or materially revise product areas without changing the foundational model.

Patch versions correct ambiguity, evidence references, terminology, or editorial defects.

Durable changes require a Product Decision Record (PDR), affected-chapter update, feature-status update, and changelog entry.

Public claims must be checked against the Current Product and TestFlight scope chapters before publication.

Executive Summary

CloseCut is the private home for a person's entertainment life. It helps people remember what they watched, preserve why it mattered, understand how their taste changes, make a focused next decision, and coordinate selectively with people they trust.

The current TestFlight beta is substantially broader than the historical "private emotional journal" concept. Repository evidence shows a personal journal and library, activation through Quick Add, TMDB-backed search and discovery, a rule-based QuickPick engine, a private Want to Watch list, membership-based Circles, selected entry sharing, reactions, comments, Watch Together plans, local Battle modes, Awards & Culture predictions, personal insights, wrap-style summaries, appearance/language controls, and local-first synchronization infrastructure. The product also has material limitations: no real-time listeners or background sync, no automatic retry scheduler, no Group QuickPick, no push social notifications, incomplete account-deletion and profile lifecycle, limited moderation, and dependency on TMDB and Firebase configuration.

The canonical model has four product pillars:

Personal Memory - one private archive for quick records and rich memories.

Taste and Decision Support - explainable tools that reduce decision fatigue without claiming certainty.

Trusted Coordination - selected sharing, Circles, plans, comments, and reactions in explicit context.

Calm, Reliable Experience - native-feeling interaction, accessibility, local continuity, and honest system state.

CloseCut is not a public review network, streaming service, social graph, infinite recommendation feed, or opaque AI product. Its long-term opportunity is to become a durable entertainment memory system across platforms, with richer taste interpretation, cinema intelligence, shared memories, and assistive insights. That expansion is valid only if privacy, trust, and personal ownership remain stronger than feature breadth.

PART I - FOUNDATION

1. Vision

Purpose. Defines the enduring future CloseCut is trying to create, independently of a particular interface or release.

Product Intent

CloseCut is the private home for a person's entertainment life: a durable place to remember, understand, decide, and selectively share. The product should grow more useful as personal history accumulates, rather than becoming obsolete as individual titles leave cultural attention.

Current Product Interpretation

Current product already unifies private journal, discovery, decision support, saved titles, Circles, plans, and personal summaries.

Near-Term Direction

Strengthen the relationship among history, choice, and social context without increasing cognitive load.

Long-Term Vision

Become a trusted entertainment memory system spanning platforms and life stages.

Vision Statement

CloseCut is the private home for your entertainment life.

The phrase *private home* establishes ownership, safety, continuity, and return. *Entertainment life* is broader than a watch journal but narrower than a general life-logging platform. It includes watched memories, future intentions, decision moments, cinema context, and trusted shared plans.

Enduring Outcomes

A person can reconstruct what they watched and why it mattered.

Their archive reveals change without reducing identity to a fixed score.

The next choice becomes easier because prior context remains usable.

Sharing remains selective, understandable, and reversible.

The archive survives changes in streaming platforms, trends, and social networks.

Guiding Principle

CloseCut is not designed to make people watch more. It is designed to help them value what they watch.

graph LR

A[Viewing experience] --> B[Personal memory]

B --> C[History]

C --> D[Taste understanding]

D --> E[Decision confidence]

E --> A

Implications

A feature that increases content volume but weakens ownership, reflection, or trust is not automatically progress. Product success must be evaluated through durable value, not session length.

Anti-Patterns

Positioning the product as a universal streaming catalog.

Treating public reach as the default measure of social value.

Presenting taste as a permanent label or competitive score.

Using recommendation certainty that the available signals cannot support.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

2. Product Philosophy

Purpose. Establishes the rules used to evaluate every product decision.

Product Intent

Memory over ratings; identity over lists; private by default; fast when needed and rich when wanted; explain decisions; calm technology; local-first trust; social intimacy over scale.

Current Product Interpretation

The current codebase materially reflects these principles through one Entry model, local persistence, explicit sharing, and rule-based QuickPick.

Near-Term Direction

Remove remaining places where discovery or feature breadth can overshadow the personal archive.

Long-Term Vision

Maintain these principles even if the product expands into richer intelligence and additional platforms.

Foundational Principles

Memory over Ratings

Ratings may exist as a private signal, but they must never displace context, mood, or personal language as the meaning of an entry.

Identity over Lists

Lists store objects. CloseCut should reveal continuity, change, and personal relevance across time.

Private by Default

Privacy is a behavioral default and an information architecture rule, not only a policy statement.

Fast When Needed, Rich When Wanted

Quick Add and full journal entries are equally legitimate states of one history object. The product must not punish a person for choosing speed.

One Thoughtful Pick

Decision support should narrow a moment of uncertainty, not create another feed to manage.

Explain the System

Recommendation reasons, sync states, sharing targets, and errors must be understandable without technical knowledge.

Calm Technology

No streaks, forced urgency, addictive loops, public leaderboards, or manipulative return prompts.

Taste Evolves

Insights should describe patterns with humility and time context. They must not define the person.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

3. The Problem

Purpose. Describes the underlying market and human problems without presupposing a CloseCut solution.

Product Intent

Entertainment consumption is abundant but personal continuity is weak. Viewing memories fragment across services, public platforms reward performative opinions, and choice interfaces create more options than confidence.

Current Product Interpretation

The beta addresses memory fragmentation and decision fatigue but cannot yet prove long-term retention.

Near-Term Direction

Validate which memory cues and decision moments create recurring value.

Long-Term Vision

Create continuity across years of viewing and changing services.

Problem Landscape

Memory Fragmentation

Viewing history is distributed across service histories, screenshots, messages, notes, public lists, ticket emails, and unreliable recall. These artifacts preserve fragments but rarely form a coherent personal archive.

Context Loss

A title alone does not preserve who was present, where it was watched, what mood surrounded it, or why it remained meaningful.

Decision Overload

Discovery systems maximize available options. People still lack confidence about the single option that fits the current moment.

Public Performance Pressure

Ratings and reviews often become statements to an audience. This can discourage imperfect, intimate, or evolving reflection.

Platform Discontinuity

Streaming catalogs, apps, and social platforms change. A personal archive tied to one catalog or public network is fragile.

Coordination Loss

Group decisions and recommendations disappear into chats without durable context or ownership.

Research Hypotheses

A seeded personal history creates more first-session value than an empty rich-journal form.

Focused recommendations with reasons produce more confidence than undifferentiated feeds.

Explicit private sharing increases willingness to record honest reactions.

Memory resurfacing creates return value beyond title tracking.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

4. Why Existing Solutions Fall Short

Purpose. Maps the gap among databases, social film platforms, streaming services, generic notes, spreadsheets, and unaided memory.

Product Intent

Each existing tool optimizes a different job: canonical metadata, public conversation, immediate playback, free-form capture, structured tracking, or effortless recall. None combines private memory, evolving taste, focused choice, and trusted context with low friction.

Current Product Interpretation

CloseCut complements rather than replaces these tools.

Near-Term Direction

Improve import/export and interoperability while preserving the distinct private-first model.

Long-Term Vision

Become the durable personal layer across changing catalogs and platforms.

Category Comparison

Category

Optimized job

Structural limitation for this product space

Public film social platforms

Review, rate, list, and discuss publicly

Reflection is shaped by audience and public identity

Databases such as IMDb

Canonical title and industry information

Little personal memory or trusted-context continuity

Streaming services

Find and play available content

History is service-specific and optimized for consumption

Watchlists

Store future candidates

Lists rarely resolve the current decision or preserve meaning

Generic notes

Free-form private capture

No entertainment-specific retrieval, metadata, or decision loop

Spreadsheets

Structured personal tracking

High maintenance and weak emotional or mobile interaction

Unaided memory

Zero setup

Incomplete, difficult to search, and vulnerable to time

Strategic Space

CloseCut occupies the intersection of private memory, entertainment-specific structure, explainable decision support, and trusted group context. It should integrate with or coexist beside public and playback tools rather than claim to replace every category.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

5. Product Positioning

Purpose. Defines category, audience, differentiation, and boundaries.

Product Intent

Category: private entertainment memory and decision system. Primary promise: More than ratings. Supporting promise: remember what you watched, understand your taste, and make the next choice easier.

Current Product Interpretation

TestFlight positioning should stay narrower than the long-term ecosystem and only claim implemented capabilities.

Near-Term Direction

Refine language through tester comprehension and App Store conversion.

Long-Term Vision

Own the private entertainment memory category rather than competing for public review scale.

Canonical Positioning

Category. Private entertainment memory and decision system.

Primary promise. More than ratings.

Functional articulation. Remember what you watched. Understand your taste. Make the next choice easier.

Social articulation. Private by default. Share only what you choose, with the people you choose.

Primary Audience

People who watch movies or series regularly and want continuity, personal meaning, or decision support without maintaining a public persona.

Secondary Audience

Small trusted groups that already exchange recommendations and plans in fragmented conversations.

Poor Fit

People seeking a public critic identity as the primary job.

Users who only want streaming-provider availability.

Users expecting automated certainty from minimal history.

Communities requiring large-scale public moderation or viral discovery.

Public Claim Rule

Marketing must describe current TestFlight behavior, not the complete long-term system. “AI-powered,” “real-time,” “available everywhere,” or “fully private” are prohibited unless evidence and policy support the exact claim.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

6. Product Identity

Purpose. Defines the product personality, emotional outcome, voice, values, and editorial behavior.

Product Intent

CloseCut is thoughtful, intimate, calm, premium, curious, and nonjudgmental. It speaks clearly and warmly, avoids exaggerated intelligence claims, and treats the person's words as primary content.

Current Product Interpretation

The app's dark editorial design, typography, privacy copy, and brand character broadly support this identity.

Near-Term Direction

Unify product, website, App Store, and social language through a canonical content system.

Long-Term Vision

Remain recognizable across iOS, Android, web reading experiences, and physical or event touchpoints.

Personality

Thoughtful, private, calm, cinematic, warm, precise, curious, and nonjudgmental.

Emotional Goals

A person should feel: "This is mine," "I can remember," "I understand why this is here," "I am in control of sharing," and "I can decide without browsing forever."

Voice

Use short, direct, human sentences.

Prefer invitation over instruction.

Describe system limitations honestly.

Avoid judgment about taste, completion, frequency, or genre.

Avoid startup superlatives and algorithmic mystique.

Editorial Language

Use *memory*, *history*, *watched*, *saved*, *Circle*, *plan*, *reason*, and *private*. Use *intelligence* only for clearly bounded product interpretation, never as an unsupported capability claim.

Brand-to-Product Consistency

The visual identity may be expressive, but interaction surfaces should keep the user's content primary. Marketing can use the CloseCut character and purple glow as brand signals; product UI must preserve editorial restraint and native legibility.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

7. Personas

Purpose. Defines a small set of behavior-based archetypes rather than demographic stereotypes.

Product Intent

Four primary personas: the Memory Keeper, the Taste Builder, the Decision Seeker, and the Trusted Coordinator. A person may move among these modes.

Current Product Interpretation

Current features serve all four, though the broad surface area risks obscuring the primary activation path.

Near-Term Direction

Use onboarding and progressive disclosure to meet the current job without presenting the whole system at once.

Long-Term Vision

Support deeper longitudinal and group use without splitting the product into disconnected modes.

Persona 1 - The Memory Keeper

Job: Preserve a meaningful record without writing formal reviews.

Trigger: Finishing a title, revisiting an old favorite, or recalling a shared moment.

Success: The memory is captured quickly enough to remain honest and is easy to rediscover later.

Failure: The form feels like work or the archive becomes a flat list.

Persona 2 - The Taste Builder

Job: See patterns and change across a growing archive.

Trigger: Browsing personal history, summaries, or resurfaced memories.

Success: Insights feel recognizable but not deterministic.

Failure: The product turns taste into a fixed label or vanity score.

Persona 3 - The Decision Seeker

Job: Reduce uncertainty in the current moment.

Trigger: “I do not know what to watch.”

Success: One option and a credible reason create confidence or useful rejection.

Failure: Another infinite feed, repeated titles, or unexplained suggestions.

Persona 4 - The Trusted Coordinator

Job: Share selected memories and turn conversation into a concrete plan.

Trigger: A partner, family, or friends want to watch something together.

Success: Context, ownership, and responses remain attached to a named Circle.

Failure: Accidental oversharing, public behavior, or chat replacement complexity.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

8. Core Product Loop

Purpose. Defines how durable value compounds.

Product Intent

Watch or encounter a title → capture or save it → revisit and reflect → recognize patterns → make a focused decision → share or plan when useful → return with more context.

Current Product Interpretation

The beta implements all nodes, although sync and notification limitations weaken automatic return moments.

Near-Term Direction

Instrument the loop and identify the strongest activation and retention transitions.

Long-Term Vision

Create increasingly useful resurfacing and decision support without manipulating attention.

Loop Definition

graph TD

A[Encounter or watch a title] --> B{Current intent}

B --> |Remember| C[Quick Add or Journal Entry]

B --> |Consider| D[Want to Watch]

B --> |Decide| E[QuickPick, Discover, or Battle]

C --> F[Timeline and Library]

D --> E

E --> G[Watch Plan or watch]

G --> C

F --> H[Insights and resurfacing]

H --> E

C --> I[Selected Circle sharing]

I --> G

Activation Loop

Onboard → add several past watches or start fresh → see a personal archive → receive a useful next action.

Retention Loop

New viewing or decision need → use existing history → capture outcome → history gains value.

Social Loop

Select a memory or candidate → share in one Circle → react, comment, or plan → preserve the result in personal context.

Healthy-Loop Constraint

The loop must not depend on anxiety, streak loss, public response, or artificial scarcity.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

9. Information Architecture

Purpose. Defines the conceptual domains and their boundaries, not only tabs.

Product Intent

Five mental spaces: Personal Memory, Decide, Discover, Trusted Social, and Account/Trust. Features may appear in more than one navigation surface, but ownership remains explicit.

Current Product Interpretation

The current app contains corresponding feature areas across Home, Discover, Social, Battle, Watchlist, and Settings.

Near-Term Direction

Reduce navigation ambiguity and clarify the relationship between Timeline, Library, Discover, QuickPick, Battle, and Plans.

Long-Term Vision

Allow future platforms to express the same mental model with different native navigation.

Mental Domains

Personal Memory

Entries, Timeline, Library, details, insights, wraps, and owner lifecycle.

Decide

QuickPick, Want to Watch, Battle, and plan creation.

Discover

Search, trending/popular metadata, title preview, and external enrichment.

Trusted Social

Circles, selected sharing, shared timelines, reactions, comments, and Watch Together.

Account and Trust

Authentication, profile, privacy, language, appearance, sync, notifications, support, and deletion.

Boundary Rules

Personal entries do not become social content without explicit selected-Circle sharing.

Discover metadata does not become personal history until a person saves or records it.

A watchlist candidate is an intention, not a watched memory.

A Battle outcome is a decision artifact, not automatically a personal taste fact.

Circle context cannot read private-only personal records.

Navigation Principle

Navigation may evolve, but every surface must make the current domain, ownership, and next action clear.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

PART II - PRODUCT SYSTEM

10. Product Pillars

Purpose. Personal Memory; Taste and Decision Support; Trusted Coordination; Calm, Reliable Experience.

Status: Implemented

User Need

People need one coherent product rather than a collection of unrelated media utilities.

Product Behavior

The system is organized around four pillars: Personal Memory, Taste and Decision Support, Trusted Coordination, and Calm Reliable Experience. Every feature must have one primary pillar and may support others.

Current Implementation

Authentication and Session (implemented). Email/password authentication and session gating are present. Password reset and email verification are not surfaced.

CloseCut/Core/Services/AuthService.swift

CloseCut/Core/Services/SessionViewModel.swift

Onboarding (implemented). Start-fresh and Quick Add activation paths are implemented.

CloseCut/Features/Onboarding

Quick Add Past Watches (implemented). TMDB search, local fallback, manual entry, duplicate prevention, quick sentiment, approximate date, and upgrade path are present.

CloseCut/Features/QuickAdd

Personal Journal Entries (implemented). Rich entry creation/editing, soft delete, metadata, mood, tags, notes, quotes, context, cinema fields, and sharing targets are present.

CloseCut/Features/Entries

CloseCut/Core/Local/LocalEntry.swift

Near-Term Direction

Clarify feature hierarchy in navigation and public messaging; remove duplication among decision surfaces.

Long-Term Vision

The pillars remain stable while individual features and navigation evolve.

Requirements

The Product Pillars experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Product Pillars without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

Edge Cases

No local data and no network.

Local data exists while the remote copy is older or unavailable.

The user revokes permission or loses Circle membership during an active flow.

Metadata becomes unavailable after an item has been saved.

The app is terminated during a pending write or navigation transition.

The same item is encountered through multiple origins or contexts.

Privacy and Accessibility Implications

The feature must minimize collected data, preserve context boundaries, expose sharing and synchronization states in language, and support VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, sufficient contrast, reduced motion, and non-color status.

Success Signals

People complete the intended job without needing support or external explanation.

The feature creates a meaningful transition to another core loop step.

Reported accidental sharing, lost data, and unrecoverable errors remain near zero.

Qualitative feedback describes increased memory value, decision confidence, or trusted coordination.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

PDR-007 One Entry Model

PDR-008 Explain Recommendations

PDR-009 Explicit Circle Context

PDR-010 Calm, Native Interaction

11. Personal History

Purpose. A private, owner-controlled archive unifying lightweight and rich records.

Status: Implemented

User Need

I want my watched history to remain mine, become easier to revisit, and accept both lightweight and detailed records.

Product Behavior

Personal History owns watched records. It combines Quick Add and full entries through one identity, keeps ownership explicit, supports local rendering, and separates private records from Circle context.

Current Implementation

Personal Journal Entries (implemented). Rich entry creation/editing, soft delete, metadata, mood, tags, notes, quotes, context, cinema fields, and sharing targets are present.

CloseCut/Features/Entries

CloseCut/Core/Local/LocalEntry.swift

Near-Term Direction

Improve import/export, section logic, and longitudinal resurfacing while protecting simple browsing.

Long-Term Vision

A cross-platform archive owned by the person, with durable export and migration.

Requirements

The Personal History experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Personal History without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

Edge Cases

No local data and no network.

Local data exists while the remote copy is older or unavailable.

The user revokes permission or loses Circle membership during an active flow.

Metadata becomes unavailable after an item has been saved.

The app is terminated during a pending write or navigation transition.

The same item is encountered through multiple origins or contexts.

Privacy and Accessibility Implications

The feature must minimize collected data, preserve context boundaries, expose sharing and synchronization states in language, and support VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, sufficient contrast, reduced motion, and non-color status.

Success Signals

People complete the intended job without needing support or external explanation.

The feature creates a meaningful transition to another core loop step.

Reported accidental sharing, lost data, and unrecoverable errors remain near zero.

Qualitative feedback describes increased memory value, decision confidence, or trusted coordination.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

PDR-007 One Entry Model

PDR-008 Explain Recommendations

PDR-009 Explicit Circle Context

12. Quick Add Past Watches

Purpose. A fast title-first activation and history-building flow.

Status: Implemented

User Need

I want to seed my history quickly without completing a long journal form.

Product Behavior

Quick Add lets a person search, select, or manually enter several previously watched titles with minimal required input. Optional sentiment and approximate date deepen the record without blocking capture.

Current Implementation

Quick Add Past Watches (implemented). TMDB search, local fallback, manual entry, duplicate prevention, quick sentiment, approximate date, and upgrade path are present.

CloseCut/Features/QuickAdd

QuickPick (implemented). Local rule-based engine, reasons, confidence labels, no-repeat, rewatch logic, local heuristics, and TMDB-backed candidate discovery are present.

CloseCut/Recommendation

CloseCut/Features/Home/QuickPick

Group QuickPick (future). Circle-level recommendation remains placeholder/not implemented.

CloseCut/Features/Social/Circle

Near-Term Direction

Measure completion, duplicate confusion, and upgrade behavior; optimize for several additions in one session.

Long-Term Vision

Optional imports and intelligent assistance that preserve user confirmation and data provenance.

Requirements

The Quick Add Past Watches experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Quick Add Past Watches without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

Edge Cases

No local data and no network.

Local data exists while the remote copy is older or unavailable.

The user revokes permission or loses Circle membership during an active flow.

Metadata becomes unavailable after an item has been saved.

The app is terminated during a pending write or navigation transition.

The same item is encountered through multiple origins or contexts.

Privacy and Accessibility Implications

The feature must minimize collected data, preserve context boundaries, expose sharing and synchronization states in language, and support VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, sufficient contrast, reduced motion, and non-color status.

Success Signals

People complete the intended job without needing support or external explanation.

The feature creates a meaningful transition to another core loop step.

Reported accidental sharing, lost data, and unrecoverable errors remain near zero.

Qualitative feedback describes increased memory value, decision confidence, or trusted coordination.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

PDR-007 One Entry Model

PDR-008 Explain Recommendations

PDR-009 Explicit Circle Context

PDR-010 Calm, Native Interaction

13. Timeline

Purpose. A temporal and editorial memory surface, not a generic social feed.

Status: Implemented

User Need

I want to browse my past as a meaningful archive rather than a chronological database dump.

Product Behavior

Timeline prioritizes recency and meaningful sections while supporting search, filters, memory cues, and both lightweight and rich cards. It avoids social-feed semantics.

Current Implementation

Timeline and Library (implemented). Timeline, search, filters, sections, insights, and wrap-style summaries are present.

CloseCut/Features/Home/Timeline

CloseCut/Features/Home/Library

Near-Term Direction

Validate which sections and cues increase meaningful return without making the archive feel algorithmically rearranged.

Long-Term Vision

A living personal narrative with meaningful seasonal and multi-year resurfacing.

Requirements

The Timeline experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Timeline without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

Edge Cases

No local data and no network.

Local data exists while the remote copy is older or unavailable.

The user revokes permission or loses Circle membership during an active flow.

Metadata becomes unavailable after an item has been saved.

The app is terminated during a pending write or navigation transition.

The same item is encountered through multiple origins or contexts.

Privacy and Accessibility Implications

The feature must minimize collected data, preserve context boundaries, expose sharing and synchronization states in language, and support VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, sufficient contrast, reduced motion, and non-color status.

Success Signals

People complete the intended job without needing support or external explanation.

The feature creates a meaningful transition to another core loop step.

Reported accidental sharing, lost data, and unrecoverable errors remain near zero.

Qualitative feedback describes increased memory value, decision confidence, or trusted coordination.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

PDR-007 One Entry Model

PDR-008 Explain Recommendations

PDR-009 Explicit Circle Context

PDR-010 Calm, Native Interaction

14. Full Journal Entries

Purpose. The rich reflection layer for mood, context, notes, tags, quotes, metadata, and cinema experience.

Status: Implemented

User Need

I want to preserve what stayed with me while the experience is still available in memory.

Product Behavior

The full editor captures title, mood, date, notes, quote, tags, context, cinema details, metadata, and selected sharing targets using progressive disclosure.

Current Implementation

Repository evidence is distributed across the UI design system, feature views, accessibility audit, and QA checklist. This specification treats accessibility as partially verified until a complete device-level audit passes.

Near-Term Direction

Reduce form fatigue, strengthen draft recovery, and preserve a fast default path.

Long-Term Vision

Flexible capture ranging from seconds to deep reflection, including voice or assisted structuring only with consent.

Requirements

The Full Journal Entries experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Full Journal Entries without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

Edge Cases

No local data and no network.

Local data exists while the remote copy is older or unavailable.

The user revokes permission or loses Circle membership during an active flow.

Metadata becomes unavailable after an item has been saved.

The app is terminated during a pending write or navigation transition.

The same item is encountered through multiple origins or contexts.

Privacy and Accessibility Implications

The feature must minimize collected data, preserve context boundaries, expose sharing and synchronization states in language, and support VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, sufficient contrast, reduced motion, and non-color status.

Success Signals

People complete the intended job without needing support or external explanation.

The feature creates a meaningful transition to another core loop step.

Reported accidental sharing, lost data, and unrecoverable errors remain near zero.

Qualitative feedback describes increased memory value, decision confidence, or trusted coordination.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

PDR-007 One Entry Model

PDR-008 Explain Recommendations

PDR-009 Explicit Circle Context

PDR-010 Calm, Native Interaction

15. Entry Detail and Memory Preservation

Purpose. The canonical reading surface for one memory and its owner-controlled lifecycle.

Status: Implemented

User Need

I want one trustworthy place to reread, complete, edit, share, or remove a memory I own.

Product Behavior

Entry Detail displays the complete memory, metadata, ownership, visibility, and sync status. Edit and delete remain owner actions; Circle detail remains read-only.

Current Implementation

Private Entry Sharing (implemented). Selected Circle sharing is explicit and private by default. Circle-side entry detail is read-only.

CloseCut/Features/Entries

CloseCut/Features/Social/Circle

Near-Term Direction

Improve memory resurfacing, sharing clarity, and lifecycle confidence.

Long-Term Vision

A rich, portable memory object linking personal, cinema, and trusted shared context.

Requirements

The Entry Detail and Memory Preservation experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Entry Detail and Memory Preservation without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

Edge Cases

No local data and no network.

Local data exists while the remote copy is older or unavailable.

The user revokes permission or loses Circle membership during an active flow.

Metadata becomes unavailable after an item has been saved.

The app is terminated during a pending write or navigation transition.

The same item is encountered through multiple origins or contexts.

Privacy and Accessibility Implications

The feature must minimize collected data, preserve context boundaries, expose sharing and synchronization states in language, and support VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, sufficient contrast, reduced motion, and non-color status.

Success Signals

People complete the intended job without needing support or external explanation.

The feature creates a meaningful transition to another core loop step.

Reported accidental sharing, lost data, and unrecoverable errors remain near zero.

Qualitative feedback describes increased memory value, decision confidence, or trusted coordination.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

PDR-007 One Entry Model

PDR-008 Explain Recommendations

PDR-009 Explicit Circle Context

PDR-010 Calm, Native Interaction

16. QuickPick

Purpose. A focused, rule-based, explainable personal recommendation experience.

Status: Implemented

User Need

I want one credible option when I cannot decide, with a reason I understand and can reject.

Product Behavior

QuickPick evaluates candidate sources with local rules, filters watched items unless intentionally resurfacing a rewatch, avoids same-session repetition, and shows a reason and confidence label.

Current Implementation

QuickPick (implemented). Local rule-based engine, reasons, confidence labels, no-repeat, rewatch logic, local heuristics, and TMDB-backed candidate discovery are present.

CloseCut/Recommendation

CloseCut/Features/Home/QuickPick

Group QuickPick (future). Circle-level recommendation remains placeholder/not implemented.

CloseCut/Features/Social/Circle

Near-Term Direction

Strengthen candidate quality, reason accuracy, dismissal learning, and distinction between rewatch and unwatched discovery.

Long-Term Vision

More adaptive decision support with transparent signal controls and no black-box authority.

Requirements

The QuickPick experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of QuickPick without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

Edge Cases

No local data and no network.

Local data exists while the remote copy is older or unavailable.

The user revokes permission or loses Circle membership during an active flow.

Metadata becomes unavailable after an item has been saved.

The app is terminated during a pending write or navigation transition.

The same item is encountered through multiple origins or contexts.

Privacy and Accessibility Implications

The feature must minimize collected data, preserve context boundaries, expose sharing and synchronization states in language, and support VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, sufficient contrast, reduced motion, and non-color status.

Success Signals

People complete the intended job without needing support or external explanation.

The feature creates a meaningful transition to another core loop step.

Reported accidental sharing, lost data, and unrecoverable errors remain near zero.

Qualitative feedback describes increased memory value, decision confidence, or trusted coordination.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

PDR-007 One Entry Model

PDR-008 Explain Recommendations

PDR-009 Explicit Circle Context

PDR-010 Calm, Native Interaction

17. Watchlist and Decision Support

Purpose. A private staging area connecting discovery, decisions, and eventual history.

Status: Implemented

User Need

I want to keep candidates without confusing intention with history, and move them naturally toward a decision.

Product Behavior

Want to Watch stores private candidates and supports save, dismiss, mark watched, convert to history, enter Battle, or create a plan. Status must never imply that a candidate was watched.

Current Implementation

Want to Watch (implemented). Private saved list, status handling, mark watched, conversion to Quick Add, and push/pull sync are present.

CloseCut/Features/Watchlist

CloseCut/Core/Repositories/WatchlistRepository.swift

Near-Term Direction

Unify status vocabulary and ensure conversion to watched history is intentional and reversible.

Long-Term Vision

A universal private queue interoperable with plans and availability while remaining distinct from watched history.

Requirements

The Watchlist and Decision Support experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Watchlist and Decision Support without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

Edge Cases

No local data and no network.

Local data exists while the remote copy is older or unavailable.

The user revokes permission or loses Circle membership during an active flow.

Metadata becomes unavailable after an item has been saved.

The app is terminated during a pending write or navigation transition.

The same item is encountered through multiple origins or contexts.

Privacy and Accessibility Implications

The feature must minimize collected data, preserve context boundaries, expose sharing and synchronization states in language, and support VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, sufficient contrast, reduced motion, and non-color status.

Success Signals

People complete the intended job without needing support or external explanation.

The feature creates a meaningful transition to another core loop step.

Reported accidental sharing, lost data, and unrecoverable errors remain near zero.

Qualitative feedback describes increased memory value, decision confidence, or trusted coordination.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

PDR-007 One Entry Model

PDR-008 Explain Recommendations

PDR-009 Explicit Circle Context

PDR-010 Calm, Native Interaction

18. Search and Metadata

Purpose. TMDB-backed and local/manual mechanisms that reduce capture friction without making metadata the product.

Status: Implemented

User Need

I want fast, accurate title selection while retaining a manual path when metadata is unavailable.

Product Behavior

Search uses TMDB where configured, local suggestions and cached metadata where available, and manual fallback. Metadata enriches capture and discovery but cannot block a private record.

Current Implementation

Discover and Search (implemented). Trending, popular, media search, detail previews, genre affinity, and TMDB metadata are present; availability providers are not.

CloseCut/Features/Discover

CloseCut/Features/Search

CloseCut/Core/External/TMDB

Near-Term Direction

Improve failure handling, metadata refresh, attribution, and offline/manual continuity.

Long-Term Vision

Provider-aware and region-aware enrichment without becoming a playback catalog.

Requirements

The Search and Metadata experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Search and Metadata without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

Edge Cases

No local data and no network.

Local data exists while the remote copy is older or unavailable.

The user revokes permission or loses Circle membership during an active flow.

Metadata becomes unavailable after an item has been saved.

The app is terminated during a pending write or navigation transition.

The same item is encountered through multiple origins or contexts.

Privacy and Accessibility Implications

The feature must minimize collected data, preserve context boundaries, expose sharing and synchronization states in language, and support VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, sufficient contrast, reduced motion, and non-color status.

Success Signals

People complete the intended job without needing support or external explanation.

The feature creates a meaningful transition to another core loop step.

Reported accidental sharing, lost data, and unrecoverable errors remain near zero.

Qualitative feedback describes increased memory value, decision confidence, or trusted coordination.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

PDR-007 One Entry Model

PDR-008 Explain Recommendations

PDR-009 Explicit Circle Context

PDR-010 Calm, Native Interaction

19. Cinema Experience Intelligence

Purpose. Capture and future interpretation of where and how cinema experiences affect memory.

Status: Partial

User Need

I want to remember the quality and context of a cinema visit, not only the title.

Product Behavior

Cinema capture records venue and room/context signals such as screen, audio, and comfort. Current product preserves the memory; future intelligence may summarize personal venue patterns.

Current Implementation

Cinema Experience Intelligence (partial). Cinema context and experience fields exist. Longitudinal cinema insights and aggregated anonymous intelligence are future.

CloseCut/Core/Domain/Models/Entry/CinemaIntelligenceModels.swift

CloseCut/Features/Entries

Near-Term Direction

Ship a clean personal cinema summary before considering any anonymous aggregation.

Long-Term Vision

Personal venue intelligence and carefully governed anonymous insights that never expose individual attendance patterns.

Requirements

The Cinema Experience Intelligence experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Acceptance Criteria

Implemented behavior is available without implying that missing reliability or ecosystem capabilities already exist.

A new user can understand the purpose of Cinema Experience Intelligence without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

Edge Cases

No local data and no network.

Local data exists while the remote copy is older or unavailable.

The user revokes permission or loses Circle membership during an active flow.

Metadata becomes unavailable after an item has been saved.

The app is terminated during a pending write or navigation transition.

The same item is encountered through multiple origins or contexts.

Privacy and Accessibility Implications

The feature must minimize collected data, preserve context boundaries, expose sharing and synchronization states in language, and support VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, sufficient contrast, reduced motion, and non-color status.

Success Signals

People complete the intended job without needing support or external explanation.

The feature creates a meaningful transition to another core loop step.

Reported accidental sharing, lost data, and unrecoverable errors remain near zero.

Qualitative feedback describes increased memory value, decision confidence, or trusted coordination.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

PDR-007 One Entry Model

PDR-008 Explain Recommendations

PDR-009 Explicit Circle Context

PDR-010 Calm, Native Interaction

20. Circles

Purpose. Membership-based private spaces for multiple trusted contexts.

Status: Implemented

User Need

I want separate private spaces for the different people with whom I discuss or plan entertainment.

Product Behavior

Circle Hub lists memberships. Each Circle owns a detail space, members, shared timeline, activity, comments, reactions, and plans. Membership records drive access.

Current Implementation

Circles (implemented). Multiple circles, create/join preview, hub, detail, members, leave/edit/delete, shared timeline, and membership model are present.

CloseCut/Features/Social/Circle

CloseCut/Core/Local/LocalCircleMembership.swift

Near-Term Direction

Improve Circle detail organization, membership lifecycle, and sync clarity.

Long-Term Vision

Richer trusted spaces with shared memories and group decisions, still without public social creep.

Requirements

The Circles experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Circles without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

Edge Cases

No local data and no network.

Local data exists while the remote copy is older or unavailable.

The user revokes permission or loses Circle membership during an active flow.

Metadata becomes unavailable after an item has been saved.

The app is terminated during a pending write or navigation transition.

The same item is encountered through multiple origins or contexts.

Privacy and Accessibility Implications

The feature must minimize collected data, preserve context boundaries, expose sharing and synchronization states in language, and support VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, sufficient contrast, reduced motion, and non-color status.

Success Signals

People complete the intended job without needing support or external explanation.

The feature creates a meaningful transition to another core loop step.

Reported accidental sharing, lost data, and unrecoverable errors remain near zero.

Qualitative feedback describes increased memory value, decision confidence, or trusted coordination.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

PDR-007 One Entry Model

PDR-008 Explain Recommendations

PDR-009 Explicit Circle Context

PDR-010 Calm, Native Interaction

21. Private Sharing

Purpose. Explicit owner-directed visibility from Personal into selected Circles.

Status: Implemented

User Need

I want to choose exactly which memory is shared and with which Circle.

Product Behavior

Every entry starts private. The owner selects one or more Circle IDs. Sharing is reversible, visible, and scoped. Circle access never implies access to the owner's full archive.

Current Implementation

Private Entry Sharing (implemented). Selected Circle sharing is explicit and private by default. Circle-side entry detail is read-only.

CloseCut/Features/Entries

CloseCut/Features/Social/Circle

Near-Term Direction

Add clearer visibility summaries, unshare confirmation where needed, and security-rule QA.

Long-Term Vision

Fine-grained, understandable, auditable sharing across platforms and data types.

Requirements

The Private Sharing experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Private Sharing without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

Edge Cases

No local data and no network.

Local data exists while the remote copy is older or unavailable.

The user revokes permission or loses Circle membership during an active flow.

Metadata becomes unavailable after an item has been saved.

The app is terminated during a pending write or navigation transition.

The same item is encountered through multiple origins or contexts.

Privacy and Accessibility Implications

The feature must minimize collected data, preserve context boundaries, expose sharing and synchronization states in language, and support VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, sufficient contrast, reduced motion, and non-color status.

Success Signals

People complete the intended job without needing support or external explanation.

The feature creates a meaningful transition to another core loop step.

Reported accidental sharing, lost data, and unrecoverable errors remain near zero.

Qualitative feedback describes increased memory value, decision confidence, or trusted coordination.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

PDR-007 One Entry Model

PDR-008 Explain Recommendations

PDR-009 Explicit Circle Context

PDR-010 Calm, Native Interaction

22. Watch Together

Purpose. Circle plans that turn candidate titles into lightweight, contextual coordination.

Status: Implemented

User Need

I want a group decision to become a lightweight plan without moving the conversation into a public or complex tool.

Product Behavior

Watch Together converts a specific candidate into a Circle plan with responses and status. The plan keeps the media snapshot and its origin context without becoming a chat platform.

Current Implementation

Quick Add Past Watches (implemented). TMDB search, local fallback, manual entry, duplicate prevention, quick sentiment, approximate date, and upgrade path are present.

CloseCut/Features/QuickAdd

Want to Watch (implemented). Private saved list, status handling, mark watched, conversion to Quick Add, and push/pull sync are present.

CloseCut/Features/Watchlist

CloseCut/Core/Repositories/WatchlistRepository.swift

Watch Together Plans (implemented). Plans can originate from entries, Discover, saved titles, Battle winners, and Awards & Culture nominees.

CloseCut/Features/Social/WatchTogether

CloseCut/Core/Repositories/WatchPlanRepository.swift

Near-Term Direction

Validate plan responses, closure, reminders, and conversion from plan to personal watch record.

Long-Term Vision

Collaborative planning with calendar and availability integrations, bounded by explicit consent.

Requirements

The Watch Together experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Watch Together without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

Edge Cases

No local data and no network.

Local data exists while the remote copy is older or unavailable.

The user revokes permission or loses Circle membership during an active flow.

Metadata becomes unavailable after an item has been saved.

The app is terminated during a pending write or navigation transition.

The same item is encountered through multiple origins or contexts.

Privacy and Accessibility Implications

The feature must minimize collected data, preserve context boundaries, expose sharing and synchronization states in language, and support VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, sufficient contrast, reduced motion, and non-color status.

Success Signals

People complete the intended job without needing support or external explanation.

The feature creates a meaningful transition to another core loop step.

Reported accidental sharing, lost data, and unrecoverable errors remain near zero.

Qualitative feedback describes increased memory value, decision confidence, or trusted coordination.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

PDR-007 One Entry Model

PDR-008 Explain Recommendations

PDR-009 Explicit Circle Context

PDR-010 Calm, Native Interaction

23. Reactions and Comments

Purpose. Low-pressure response tools attached to shared memories.

Status: Implemented

User Need

I want to respond casually to a trusted person's memory without writing a formal review.

Product Behavior

One active reaction per user per shared entry keeps response state clear. Comments are short and contextual. Reporting exists; stronger blocking/moderation is a release requirement discussion.

Current Implementation

Reactions and Comments (implemented). Circle reactions/comments and comment reporting are present; blocking and broader moderation remain limited.

CloseCut/Core/Domain/Models/Circle

CloseCut/Features/Social

Near-Term Direction

Complete moderation, blocking strategy, and notification behavior before broad public scale.

Long-Term Vision

Healthy small-group interaction with proportionate safety controls.

Requirements

The Reactions and Comments experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Reactions and Comments without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

Edge Cases

No local data and no network.

Local data exists while the remote copy is older or unavailable.

The user revokes permission or loses Circle membership during an active flow.

Metadata becomes unavailable after an item has been saved.

The app is terminated during a pending write or navigation transition.

The same item is encountered through multiple origins or contexts.

Privacy and Accessibility Implications

The feature must minimize collected data, preserve context boundaries, expose sharing and synchronization states in language, and support VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, sufficient contrast, reduced motion, and non-color status.

Success Signals

People complete the intended job without needing support or external explanation.

The feature creates a meaningful transition to another core loop step.

Reported accidental sharing, lost data, and unrecoverable errors remain near zero.

Qualitative feedback describes increased memory value, decision confidence, or trusted coordination.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

PDR-007 One Entry Model

PDR-008 Explain Recommendations

PDR-009 Explicit Circle Context

24. Settings, Profile and Account

Purpose. Trust, identity, appearance, language, sync, privacy, and account controls.

Status: Partial

User Need

I want to understand and control my identity, preferences, data, synchronization, and account lifecycle.

Product Behavior

Settings consolidates profile, appearance, language, privacy, support, notification preferences, sync state, app version, sign out, and account deletion lifecycle.

Current Implementation

Repository evidence is distributed across the UI design system, feature views, accessibility audit, and QA checklist. This specification treats accessibility as partially verified until a complete device-level audit passes.

Near-Term Direction

Complete account deletion, reset/verification, profile photo lifecycle, and support surfaces.

Long-Term Vision

Complete data portability, lifecycle control, and platform-consistent preferences.

Requirements

The Settings, Profile and Account experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Acceptance Criteria

Implemented behavior is available without implying that missing reliability or ecosystem capabilities already exist.

A new user can understand the purpose of Settings, Profile and Account without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

Edge Cases

No local data and no network.

Local data exists while the remote copy is older or unavailable.

The user revokes permission or loses Circle membership during an active flow.

Metadata becomes unavailable after an item has been saved.

The app is terminated during a pending write or navigation transition.

The same item is encountered through multiple origins or contexts.

Privacy and Accessibility Implications

The feature must minimize collected data, preserve context boundaries, expose sharing and synchronization states in language, and support VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, sufficient contrast, reduced motion, and non-color status.

Success Signals

People complete the intended job without needing support or external explanation.

The feature creates a meaningful transition to another core loop step.

Reported accidental sharing, lost data, and unrecoverable errors remain near zero.

Qualitative feedback describes increased memory value, decision confidence, or trusted coordination.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

PDR-007 One Entry Model

PDR-008 Explain Recommendations

PDR-009 Explicit Circle Context

PDR-010 Calm, Native Interaction

25. Authentication and Onboarding

Purpose. Access and first-session activation without allowing setup to overshadow product value.

Status: Implemented

User Need

I want secure access and immediate product value without a long setup ceremony.

Product Behavior

Authentication establishes an owned account. Onboarding communicates the private history and decision value, then offers Quick Add or Start Fresh. Product value should appear before secondary setup.

Current Implementation

Authentication and Session (implemented). Email/password authentication and session gating are present. Password reset and email verification are not surfaced.

CloseCut/Core/Services/AuthService.swift

CloseCut/Core/Services/SessionViewModel.swift

Near-Term Direction

Improve auth recovery, verification, and activation measurement without adding onboarding length.

Long-Term Vision

Secure cross-platform identity and account recovery with minimal friction.

Requirements

The Authentication and Onboarding experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Authentication and Onboarding without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

Edge Cases

No local data and no network.

Local data exists while the remote copy is older or unavailable.

The user revokes permission or loses Circle membership during an active flow.

Metadata becomes unavailable after an item has been saved.

The app is terminated during a pending write or navigation transition.

The same item is encountered through multiple origins or contexts.

Privacy and Accessibility Implications

The feature must minimize collected data, preserve context boundaries, expose sharing and synchronization states in language, and support VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, sufficient contrast, reduced motion, and non-color status.

Success Signals

People complete the intended job without needing support or external explanation.

The feature creates a meaningful transition to another core loop step.

Reported accidental sharing, lost data, and unrecoverable errors remain near zero.

Qualitative feedback describes increased memory value, decision confidence, or trusted coordination.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

PDR-007 One Entry Model

PDR-008 Explain Recommendations

PDR-009 Explicit Circle Context

PDR-010 Calm, Native Interaction

26. Notifications and Return Moments

Purpose. Respectful reminders and social updates that serve intent rather than engagement.

Status: Partial

User Need

I want useful return prompts without pressure, noise, or irrelevant alerts.

Product Behavior

Return moments may include local reminders, plan updates, resurfaced memories, or future social notifications. Every notification must have a user benefit, preference control, and deep link.

Current Implementation

Notifications (partial). Local notification surfaces exist. Push notifications and remote social activity delivery are not implemented.

CloseCut/Features/Notifications

Near-Term Direction

Define a minimal notification matrix and avoid shipping push until permissions, preferences, and delivery reliability are complete.

Long-Term Vision

Contextual, user-controlled return moments powered by personal intent rather than engagement optimization.

Requirements

The Notifications and Return Moments experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Acceptance Criteria

Implemented behavior is available without implying that missing reliability or ecosystem capabilities already exist.

A new user can understand the purpose of Notifications and Return Moments without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

Edge Cases

No local data and no network.

Local data exists while the remote copy is older or unavailable.

The user revokes permission or loses Circle membership during an active flow.

Metadata becomes unavailable after an item has been saved.

The app is terminated during a pending write or navigation transition.

The same item is encountered through multiple origins or contexts.

Privacy and Accessibility Implications

The feature must minimize collected data, preserve context boundaries, expose sharing and synchronization states in language, and support VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, sufficient contrast, reduced motion, and non-color status.

Success Signals

People complete the intended job without needing support or external explanation.

The feature creates a meaningful transition to another core loop step.

Reported accidental sharing, lost data, and unrecoverable errors remain near zero.

Qualitative feedback describes increased memory value, decision confidence, or trusted coordination.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

PDR-007 One Entry Model

PDR-008 Explain Recommendations

PDR-009 Explicit Circle Context

PDR-010 Calm, Native Interaction

27. Accessibility and Inclusive Product Behavior

Purpose. Accessible semantics, scalable layout, non-color status, and understandable language as a baseline.

Status: Partial

User Need

I want the complete product to remain understandable and operable with my accessibility settings and abilities.

Product Behavior

All core flows support scalable type, meaningful semantics, sufficient contrast, 44-point targets, motion reduction, keyboard/focus behavior where relevant, and status not conveyed by color alone.

Current Implementation

Repository evidence is distributed across the UI design system, feature views, accessibility audit, and QA checklist. This specification treats accessibility as partially verified until a complete device-level audit passes.

Near-Term Direction

Close all high-priority accessibility findings and add repeatable QA gates.

Long-Term Vision

Equivalent product value across assistive technologies, languages, sizes, and input modes.

Requirements

The Accessibility and Inclusive Product Behavior experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Acceptance Criteria

Implemented behavior is available without implying that missing reliability or ecosystem capabilities already exist.

A new user can understand the purpose of Accessibility and Inclusive Product Behavior without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

Edge Cases

No local data and no network.

Local data exists while the remote copy is older or unavailable.

The user revokes permission or loses Circle membership during an active flow.

Metadata becomes unavailable after an item has been saved.

The app is terminated during a pending write or navigation transition.

The same item is encountered through multiple origins or contexts.

Privacy and Accessibility Implications

The feature must minimize collected data, preserve context boundaries, expose sharing and synchronization states in language, and support VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, sufficient contrast, reduced motion, and non-color status.

Success Signals

People complete the intended job without needing support or external explanation.

The feature creates a meaningful transition to another core loop step.

Reported accidental sharing, lost data, and unrecoverable errors remain near zero.

Qualitative feedback describes increased memory value, decision confidence, or trusted coordination.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

PDR-007 One Entry Model

PDR-008 Explain Recommendations

PDR-009 Explicit Circle Context

PDR-010 Calm, Native Interaction

28. Offline and Trust Experience

Purpose. Local continuity, visible sync state, recoverable failure, and non-destructive reconciliation.

Status: Partial

User Need

I want to create and read safely with weak connectivity and understand what has or has not synchronized.

Product Behavior

Core local data renders immediately. Writes occur locally before remote sync where supported. Pending and failed states remain visible, recoverable, and non-destructive.

Current Implementation

Offline and Sync (partial). Local-first persistence, queue, conflict policy, push/pull, and manual/session sync exist. No real-time listeners, background sync, or automatic retry scheduler.

CloseCut/Core/Sync

CloseCut/Core/Repositories

Near-Term Direction

Add automatic retry strategy and eventually background/realtime behavior only after conflict and battery behavior are proven.

Long-Term Vision

Seamless multi-device continuity with resilient reconciliation and transparent local ownership.

Requirements

The Offline and Trust Experience experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Acceptance Criteria

Implemented behavior is available without implying that missing reliability or ecosystem capabilities already exist.

A new user can understand the purpose of Offline and Trust Experience without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

Edge Cases

No local data and no network.

Local data exists while the remote copy is older or unavailable.

The user revokes permission or loses Circle membership during an active flow.

Metadata becomes unavailable after an item has been saved.

The app is terminated during a pending write or navigation transition.

The same item is encountered through multiple origins or contexts.

Privacy and Accessibility Implications

The feature must minimize collected data, preserve context boundaries, expose sharing and synchronization states in language, and support VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, sufficient contrast, reduced motion, and non-color status.

Success Signals

People complete the intended job without needing support or external explanation.

The feature creates a meaningful transition to another core loop step.

Reported accidental sharing, lost data, and unrecoverable errors remain near zero.

Qualitative feedback describes increased memory value, decision confidence, or trusted coordination.

Related Decision Records

PDR-001 Private by Default

PDR-002 Memory over Ratings

PDR-003 Personal First, Social Second

PDR-004 One Thoughtful Pick

PDR-005 Local-First Trust

PDR-006 Membership-Based Circles

PDR-007 One Entry Model

PDR-008 Explain Recommendations

PDR-009 Explicit Circle Context

PDR-010 Calm, Native Interaction

PART III - PRODUCT RULES

29. Privacy Model

Purpose. Personal ownership, explicit selected-Circle sharing, bounded third-party processing, clear retention and deletion semantics.

Privacy Boundaries

A personal record is private unless the owner selects a Circle.

Circle membership grants access only to data shared into that Circle.

Want to Watch, private recommendations, and personal insights are not Circle data.

Group recommendation logic may use only shared group signals.

Third-party metadata requests must not include unnecessary personal journal content.

Analytics and diagnostics must be documented, minimized, and reflected in App Store privacy declarations.

Deletion and unsharing must have predictable, testable outcomes across local and remote state.

Privacy Decision Matrix

Data

Default owner

Shared by default

Eligible for selected Circle sharing

Personal entry

User

No

Yes

Want to Watch item

User

No

No in current product

QuickPick history/reasons

User

No

No

Circle comment/reaction

Circle context + author

Contextual

Already Circle-scoped

Watch Plan

Circle context

Circle members

N/A

Analytics/diagnostics

Service operator

No

N/A

Requirements

The Privacy Model experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Review Triggers

A new platform changes the relevant interaction or privacy model.

A public claim conflicts with current implementation.

User research contradicts the intended mental model.

A security, moderation, or data-retention incident exposes an incomplete rule.

A feature creates a new data type, audience, or recommendation signal.

30. Recommendation Philosophy

Purpose. Focused, explainable, user-correctable, privacy-respecting, and appropriately uncertain.

Recommendation Rules

- A recommendation is a suggestion, not a prediction of satisfaction.
- Personal QuickPick may use personal history, mood, tags, genres, sentiment, intensity, rating, rewatch signals, and available metadata.
- It must avoid already-watched titles unless intentionally identified as a rewatch.
- The reason shown must correspond to a real signal used by the engine.
- Session repetition is avoided when alternatives exist.
- A person can reject, refresh, save, plan, or record an outcome without penalty.
- Group QuickPick is future and may only use Circle-shared signals.
- “AI” or “machine learning” language is prohibited for the current rule-based engine. ## Requirements
- The Recommendation Philosophy experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.
- Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.
- Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.
- All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.
- Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.
- The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Review Triggers

A new platform changes the relevant interaction or privacy model.

A public claim conflicts with current implementation.

User research contradicts the intended mental model.

A security, moderation, or data-retention incident exposes an incomplete rule.

A feature creates a new data type, audience, or recommendation signal.

31. Taste Model

Purpose. Taste is a changing set of signals and memories, not a fixed score or identity label.

Taste as a Model, Not a Verdict

Taste is represented as time-bound signals: watched history, recurring genres and tags, moods, intensity, sentiments, private ratings where present, rewatch behavior, saved intentions, and explicit dismissals. No single signal defines the person.

Interpretation Principles

- Use probabilistic, humble language such as “you often return to” rather than “you are.”
- Distinguish recent context from long-term pattern.
- Show enough evidence to make an insight recognizable.
- Permit correction through behavior and future explicit controls.
- Avoid compatibility scores or identity labels until their social and emotional consequences are tested. ## Requirements
- The Taste Model experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.
- Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.
- Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.
- All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.
- Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.
- The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Review Triggers

A new platform changes the relevant interaction or privacy model.

A public claim conflicts with current implementation.

User research contradicts the intended mental model.

A security, moderation, or data-retention incident exposes an incomplete rule.

A feature creates a new data type, audience, or recommendation signal.

32. Social Philosophy

Purpose. Trusted context, small-group utility, no public performance, and no growth mechanics that undermine intimacy.

Social Contract

CloseCut social behavior exists to preserve context and coordinate trusted people. It is not designed to maximize reach.

- No public profiles or follower graph as a product foundation.
- No global feed or trending social content.
- No automatic sharing from personal history.
- No public reaction counts as status.
- No requirement to join a Circle to receive personal value.
- Comments and reactions remain attached to a shared memory and named Circle.
- Moderation must scale before audience size scales. ## Requirements
- The Social Philosophy experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.
- Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.
- Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.
- All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.
- Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.
- The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Review Triggers

A new platform changes the relevant interaction or privacy model.

A public claim conflicts with current implementation.

User research contradicts the intended mental model.

A security, moderation, or data-retention incident exposes an incomplete rule.

A feature creates a new data type, audience, or recommendation signal.

33. Content and Editorial Language

Purpose. Warm, precise, short, nonjudgmental, and honest about system capability.

Voice Rules

- Be specific: “Couldn’t sync this entry” instead of “Something went wrong.”
- Be honest: “Saved on this device” instead of implying cloud completion.
- Be warm without sentimentality.
- Avoid judging frequency, genre, taste, or completion.
- Avoid “smart,” “perfect,” “knows you,” or “best” unless the claim is narrowly true.
- Use consistent product terms: Personal, Timeline, Library, Quick Add, QuickPick, Your List, Circle, Watch Plan, Battle. ## Requirements
- The Content and Editorial Language experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.
- Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.
- Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.
- All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.
- Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.
- The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Review Triggers

A new platform changes the relevant interaction or privacy model.

A public claim conflicts with current implementation.

User research contradicts the intended mental model.

A security, moderation, or data-retention incident exposes an incomplete rule.

A feature creates a new data type, audience, or recommendation signal.

34. Product States and Error Philosophy

Purpose. Every feature defines loading, empty, success, offline, pending, failed, permission, and recovery behavior.

Required State Model

State

Product obligation

Loading

Preserve layout and explain delay only when meaningful

Empty

Explain why it is empty and offer the best next action

Success

Confirm the result without interrupting momentum

Offline

Preserve available work and state what will happen later

Pending

Identify the specific local action awaiting synchronization

Failed

Keep data, explain impact, and provide retry or support

Permission denied

Explain the boundary and available alternative

Partial data

Render safely and avoid fabricated placeholders

Deleted/unshared

Remove from active context while respecting retention and reconciliation rules

Requirements

The Product States and Error Philosophy experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Review Triggers

A new platform changes the relevant interaction or privacy model.

A public claim conflicts with current implementation.

User research contradicts the intended mental model.

A security, moderation, or data-retention incident exposes an incomplete rule.

A feature creates a new data type, audience, or recommendation signal.

35. Product Quality Bar

Purpose. A release must be coherent, trustworthy, accessible, responsive, and emotionally restrained—not merely feature complete.

Quality Dimensions

- **Coherence:** One vocabulary, hierarchy, and mental model.
- **Trust:** No accidental sharing, silent loss, or misleading state.
- **Utility:** The primary job completes with bounded effort.
- **Restraint:** Feature breadth does not overwhelm the current intent.
- **Accessibility:** Equivalent meaning and control, not merely technical compliance.
- **Performance:** Local content appears promptly and interaction remains responsive.
- **Release completeness:** Privacy, support, moderation, account, localization, and store requirements are part of the product. ## Requirements
- The Product Quality Bar experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.
- Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.
- Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.
- All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.
- Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.
- The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Review Triggers

A new platform changes the relevant interaction or privacy model.

A public claim conflicts with current implementation.

User research contradicts the intended mental model.

A security, moderation, or data-retention incident exposes an incomplete rule.

A feature creates a new data type, audience, or recommendation signal.

36. Anti-Patterns and Non-Goals

Purpose. Public ratings-first behavior, follower graphs, infinite feeds, opaque AI claims, accidental sharing, and metadata-heavy capture.

Prohibited Directions

- Public ratings-first or review-first product hierarchy.

- Global discovery or social feeds driven by popularity.
- Followers, influencer mechanics, public streaks, or leaderboards.
- Infinite recommendation feeds that replace focused decision support.
- Automatic Circle sharing or account-wide social defaults.
- Opaque AI claims or certainty language.
- Metadata requirements that block manual personal capture.
- Treating pending sync as completed remote persistence.
- Shipping social scale before moderation and account controls. ## Requirements
- The Anti-Patterns and Non-Goals experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.
- Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.
- Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.
- All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.
- Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.
- The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Review Triggers

A new platform changes the relevant interaction or privacy model.

A public claim conflicts with current implementation.

User research contradicts the intended mental model.

A security, moderation, or data-retention incident exposes an incomplete rule.

A feature creates a new data type, audience, or recommendation signal.

37. Product Decision Records

Purpose. A governed record of durable product decisions, alternatives, consequences, and review triggers.

Canonical Decisions

PDR-001 - Private by Default

Decision: All personal records remain private unless the owner deliberately selects a Circle.

Rationale: Trust is a prerequisite for honest reflection.

Rejected alternative: Public-by-default, account-wide sharing defaults.

Status: Current and permanent

PDR-002 - Memory over Ratings

Decision: The product prioritizes context, mood, notes, and personal meaning over public numerical scoring.

Rationale: A number is useful metadata but an incomplete memory.

Rejected alternative: Star-first interaction model.

Status: Current and permanent

PDR-003 - Personal First, Social Second

Decision: Personal history must deliver value without Circle participation.

Rationale: The private archive is the product foundation; social value is additive.

Rejected alternative: Social onboarding gate, public feed.

Status: Current and permanent

PDR-004 - One Thoughtful Pick

Decision: QuickPick presents a focused recommendation with a reason rather than an endless recommendation feed.

Rationale: Focus reduces decision fatigue and preserves agency.

Rejected alternative: Infinite algorithmic feed.

Status: Current

PDR-005 - Local-First Trust

Decision: Core creation and reading experiences render from local state; remote services add synchronization and enrichment.

Rationale: Journal moments must not depend on perfect connectivity.

Rejected alternative: Firestore-driven UI.

Status: Current and permanent

PDR-006 - Membership-Based Circles

Decision: Circle access is based on membership records, not a single profile circle ID.

Rationale: People belong to several trusted contexts.

Rejected alternative: Single active Circle model.

Status: Current

PDR-007 - One Entry Model

Decision: Quick Add and rich journal records are states of one history object.

Rationale: A fast start must be able to deepen without migration friction.

Rejected alternative: Separate quick-add database.

Status: Current

PDR-008 - Explain Recommendations

Decision: Every product recommendation needs a human-readable reason and bounded confidence.

Rationale: Explainability supports trust and correction.

Rejected alternative: Opaque certainty claims.

Status: Current

PDR-009 - Explicit Circle Context

Decision: Shared content, plans, comments, and reactions are always attached to a named Circle.

Rationale: Context prevents accidental social leakage.

Rejected alternative: Global friend feed.

Status: Current

PDR-010 - Calm, Native Interaction

Decision: CloseCut uses restrained, native-feeling interaction patterns and avoids engagement mechanics.

Rationale: The product is a reflective tool, not an attention market.

Rejected alternative: Streaks, viral prompts, aggressive badges.

Status: Current and permanent

Requirements

The Product Decision Records experience must state its primary user job clearly through hierarchy and behavior rather than explanatory feature lists.

Current behavior must remain distinguishable from future capability in product copy, release notes, marketing, and internal specifications.

Private data must not become visible outside its intended context through default state, fallback behavior, logging, analytics, or sync reconciliation.

All meaningful states must define a recovery path or an honest terminal explanation.

Accessibility behavior must be specified with the same priority as visual behavior.

The feature must add durable value to personal memory, decision confidence, trusted coordination, or product trust.

Review Triggers

A new platform changes the relevant interaction or privacy model.

A public claim conflicts with current implementation.

User research contradicts the intended mental model.

A security, moderation, or data-retention incident exposes an incomplete rule.

A feature creates a new data type, audience, or recommendation signal.

PART IV - DELIVERY AND EVOLUTION

38. Current Product Scope

Purpose. The verified beta surface from repository evidence, separated from aspiration.

Verified Current Surface

Authentication and Session - Implemented. Email/password authentication and session gating are present. Password reset and email verification are not surfaced.

Onboarding - Implemented. Start-fresh and Quick Add activation paths are implemented.

Quick Add Past Watches - Implemented. TMDB search, local fallback, manual entry, duplicate prevention, quick sentiment, approximate date, and upgrade path are present.

Personal Journal Entries - Implemented. Rich entry creation/editing, soft delete, metadata, mood, tags, notes, quotes, context, cinema fields, and sharing targets are present.

Timeline and Library - Implemented. Timeline, search, filters, sections, insights, and wrap-style summaries are present.

QuickPick - Implemented. Local rule-based engine, reasons, confidence labels, no-repeat, rewatch logic, local heuristics, and TMDB-backed candidate discovery are present.

Discover and Search - Implemented. Trending, popular, media search, detail previews, genre affinity, and TMDB metadata are present; availability providers are not.

Want to Watch - Implemented. Private saved list, status handling, mark watched, conversion to Quick Add, and push/pull sync are present.

Circles - Implemented. Multiple circles, create/join preview, hub, detail, members, leave/edit/delete, shared timeline, and membership model are present.

Private Entry Sharing - Implemented. Selected Circle sharing is explicit and private by default. Circle-side entry detail is read-only.

Reactions and Comments - Implemented. Circle reactions/comments and comment reporting are present; blocking and broader moderation remain limited.

Watch Together Plans - Implemented. Plans can originate from entries, Discover, saved titles, Battle winners, and Awards & Culture nominees.

Battle - Implemented. Personal/local choice modes exist. Results are not remote multiplayer or posted to Circle spaces.

Awards and Culture - Implemented. Local predictions and comparison with known results are present.

Insights and Wrap - Implemented. Personal summaries and insight surfaces are implemented; they are not positioned as clinical or deterministic taste analysis.

Cinema Experience Intelligence - Partial. Cinema context and experience fields exist. Longitudinal cinema insights and aggregated anonymous intelligence are future.

Notifications - Partial. Local notification surfaces exist. Push notifications and remote social activity delivery are not implemented.

Offline and Sync - Partial. Local-first persistence, queue, conflict policy, push/pull, and manual/session sync exist. No real-time listeners, background sync, or automatic retry scheduler.

Profile and Account Controls - Partial. Profile, privacy links, sync, language, appearance, sign out, and deletion preparation exist. Profile photo upload, complete account deletion, reset, and verification UI remain gaps.

Interpretation

“Current” means repository evidence exists. It does not override known limitations, missing configuration, incomplete lifecycle, or release-readiness blockers.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B. A new user can understand the purpose of Current Product Scope without external documentation. The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics. Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss. VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces. Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

39. TestFlight Scope

Purpose. A learning release centered on activation, personal history, decision support, selected private sharing, reliability, and actionable feedback.

Learning Goals

Can a new person understand the product and build an initial history?

Does the archive feel worth returning to?

Does QuickPick reduce a real decision moment?

Are privacy and Circle boundaries understood?

Do local-first and sync states create confidence or confusion?

Which broad beta surfaces create value versus navigation noise?

Tester Mission

Complete onboarding, add several past watches, create or complete a rich entry, browse Timeline/Library, try QuickPick, save or decide on a candidate, and optionally use a Circle. Report confusion, bugs, visual issues, privacy uncertainty, and missing recovery paths.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of TestFlight Scope without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

40. App Store v1 Scope

Purpose. A smaller, supportable promise with complete privacy, deletion, moderation, localization, metadata, and release readiness.

Release Gate

App Store v1 should not be defined as “everything already in the repository.” It should be the smallest coherent promise that can be supported safely. Required release completeness includes:

Stable auth and recovery path.

Working account deletion and local purge.

Accurate privacy policy and App Privacy labels.

UGC reporting and an appropriate blocking/support strategy.

Deployed and tested Firestore rules/indexes.

TMDB attribution and configuration compliance.

Localization quality for declared languages.

Accessibility and device-size QA.

Crash, analytics, and performance configuration verified.

Store metadata, screenshots, age rating, support, and review instructions complete.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of App Store v1 Scope without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

41. Near-Term Product Direction

Purpose. Improve activation, sync reliability, Circle clarity, account completeness, and the connection among Discover, decisions, and memory.

Priority Outcomes

Increase first-session activation and first meaningful history.

Reduce navigation and terminology ambiguity among Timeline, Library, Discover, Your List, QuickPick, Battle, and Plans.

Complete account lifecycle and UGC safety requirements.

Increase sync reliability and state clarity before adding realtime behavior.

Improve Circle plan closure and shared-memory usefulness.

Validate which insights and resurfacing produce return value.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Near-Term Product Direction without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

42. Long-Term Ecosystem

Purpose. Taste DNA, richer cinema intelligence, shared memories, cross-platform continuity, widgets, and carefully bounded assisted insights.

Directional Opportunities

Taste DNA

A visual, evolving summary of patterns with evidence and user correction.

Cinema Experience Intelligence

Personal venue and format insights; anonymous aggregation only after rigorous consent, privacy, and statistical thresholds.

Shared Memories

Connect memories around the same title inside explicit trusted contexts.

Cross-Platform Continuity

Android and web reading/capture experiences that preserve the canonical mental model.

Widgets and System Integrations

Private, glanceable resurfacing and plan reminders.

Assisted Insights

Optional language or pattern assistance with provenance, correction, and no hidden training on private content.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Long-Term Ecosystem without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

43. Roadmap Framework

Purpose. Outcome-based horizons: Current, Next, Later, Explore. Roadmap items require evidence and explicit dependencies.

Horizon Model

Horizon

Meaning

Commitment

Current

Shipped or in active TestFlight

Supported and measured

Next

Evidence-backed quality or lifecycle work

Planned after current release risk

Later

Coherent strategic extension

Not promised publicly

Explore

Hypothesis requiring research or prototype

No roadmap commitment

Roadmap items are expressed as outcomes with evidence, dependencies, privacy impact, and explicit non-goals.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Roadmap Framework without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

44. Success Metrics

Purpose. Measure meaningful history, activation, return value, decision support, trust, sharing utility, and reliability—not vanity engagement.

Metric Framework

North Star

Meaningful history value per active person, represented through retained records, revisits, and decisions that use prior context. No single proxy should be treated as complete.

Activation

Onboarding completion, first records, several Quick Adds, first rich entry, time to a meaningful Timeline, and first useful decision action.

Retention

D1/D7/weekly return segmented by value loop, not only app opens.

Memory Value

Entry revisits, completion/upgrades, resurfacing interactions, and successful search/retrieval.

Decision Value

QuickPick use, save/plan/watch outcomes, reason comprehension, refresh/dismiss causes, and time to choice.

Social Utility

Circle creation/join, selected sharing, meaningful responses, and plan closure—not follower or reach metrics.

Trust

Accidental-sharing reports, sync recovery, data-loss reports, deletion completion, support contacts, and privacy comprehension.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Success Metrics without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

45. Analytics Philosophy

Purpose. Collect the minimum events needed to improve the product; avoid surveillance-style behavioral exhaust.

Data-Minimization Rules

Define a decision or hypothesis before adding an event.

Avoid collecting raw journal content for analytics.

Use coarse, non-sensitive properties where sufficient.

Document retention, access, and deletion behavior.

Separate diagnostics from product analytics.

Ensure public privacy declarations match enabled SDK behavior.

Prefer qualitative interviews for meaning and confusion.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Analytics Philosophy without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

46. Experimentation Principles

Purpose. Small, reversible, hypothesis-led experiments with privacy review and qualitative interpretation.

Experiment Standard

Every experiment states the user problem, hypothesis, primary and guardrail metrics, qualitative question, duration, sample limitation, privacy review, accessibility review, rollback plan, and interpretation rule. Experiments may improve clarity or sequencing; they must not manipulate privacy defaults or conceal system state.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Experimentation Principles without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

47. Risks and Mitigations

Purpose. Scope diffusion, weak activation, sync trust, metadata dependency, social complexity, privacy mistakes, and product-message mismatch.

Risk Register

Risk

Consequence

Mitigation

Product breadth obscures core value

Weak activation and confusing marketing

Progressive disclosure; prioritize Personal Memory and focused choice

Sync ambiguity

Loss of trust

Explicit local/pending/failed states; non-destructive retry

Social scale before safety

App Store and user harm

Reporting, blocking strategy, support, bounded audience

Metadata dependency

Broken capture/discovery

Manual fallback, cached safe rendering, attribution compliance

Overclaiming intelligence

Misleading positioning

Evidence-linked reasons and prohibited claim vocabulary

Privacy mistake

Irreversible trust damage

Private defaults, explicit selected context, rule tests, audit trails

Historic docs remain active

Contradictory implementation

Archive old files and link only to canonical suite

Under-tested large views and sync paths

Regression risk

ViewModel extraction, unit/integration/UI expansion

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Risks and Mitigations without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

48. Open Questions

Purpose. Decisions requiring evidence or owner confirmation, maintained as a governed queue rather than hidden assumptions.

Decisions Requiring Human Confirmation

Is App Store v1 intentionally broad, or should Battle/Awards & Culture remain beta-only?

What is the final public category language: “private film & series journal” or the broader “private entertainment memory system”?

Which languages will be declared at launch, and what quality gate applies to each?

What blocking behavior is required for Circle UGC before public release?

Will local notifications ship in v1, and what user jobs justify them?

What exact account-deletion timeline and retention policy will be promised?

Is private rating an enduring signal or a temporary implementation detail?

Which analytics SDKs and events will be enabled in production?

What export/data-portability baseline is required for long-term trust?

What feature is the primary landing and App Store conversion story after the journal?

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Open Questions without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

49. Governance and Product Change Process

Purpose. Defines ownership, evidence requirements, decision records, status taxonomy, versioning, and review cadence.

Governance Workflow

State the user problem and evidence.

Identify affected pillars, chapters, data types, contexts, and risks.

Draft or update a PDR for durable decisions.

Assign status: Current, Next, Later, or Explore.

Define requirements, acceptance evidence, accessibility, privacy, analytics, and release implications.

Update the feature-status matrix and dependency map.

Implement behind the appropriate rollout boundary.

Validate behavior and public claims.

Record the change in the changelog.

Documentation Ownership

The product owner approves vision, scope, and public claims. Design owns interaction and content interpretation. Engineering owns implementation evidence and technical constraints. QA/release owns acceptance evidence. Privacy and safety implications require explicit review rather than implicit approval.

Acceptance Criteria

The shipped behavior matches the current-product description and evidence paths in Appendix B.

A new user can understand the purpose of Governance and Product Change Process without external documentation.

The feature does not require public identity, follower relationships, or engagement mechanics.

Offline, empty, error, permission, and pending states preserve context and do not imply data loss.

VoiceOver, Dynamic Type, contrast, touch targets, and non-color status cues are verified for the relevant surfaces.

Instrumentation, when present, measures the intended outcome rather than raw taps alone.

APPENDICES

**Appendi
x A -
Feature
Status**

Matrix

ID

Feature

Status

Evidence

Notes

F-001

Authentication and Session

Implemented

CloseCut/Core/Services/AuthService.swift; CloseCut/Core/Services/SessionViewModel.swift

Email/password authentication and session gating are present. Password reset and email verification are not surfaced.

F-002

Onboarding

Implemented

CloseCut/Features/Onboarding

Start-fresh and Quick Add activation paths are implemented.

F-003

Quick Add Past Watches

Implemented

CloseCut/Features/QuickAdd

TMDB search, local fallback, manual entry, duplicate prevention, quick sentiment, approximate date, and upgrade path are present.

F-004

Personal Journal Entries

Implemented

CloseCut/Features/Entries; CloseCut/Core/Local/LocalEntry.swift

Rich entry creation/editing, soft delete, metadata, mood, tags, notes, quotes, context, cinema fields, and sharing targets are present.

F-005

Timeline and Library

Implemented

CloseCut/Features/Home/Timeline; CloseCut/Features/Home/Library

Timeline, search, filters, sections, insights, and wrap-style summaries are present.

F-006

QuickPick

Implemented

CloseCut/Recommendation; CloseCut/Features/Home/QuickPick

Local rule-based engine, reasons, confidence labels, no-repeat, rewatch logic, local heuristics, and TMDB-backed candidate discovery are present.

F-007

Discover and Search

Implemented

CloseCut/Features/Discover; CloseCut/Features/Search; CloseCut/Core/External/TMDB

Trending, popular, media search, detail previews, genre affinity, and TMDB metadata are present; availability providers are not.

F-008

Want to Watch

Implemented

CloseCut/Features/Watchlist; CloseCut/Core/Repositories/WatchlistRepository.swift

Private saved list, status handling, mark watched, conversion to Quick Add, and push/pull sync are present.

F-009

Circles

Implemented

CloseCut/Features/Social/Circle; CloseCut/Core/Local/LocalCircleMembership.swift

Multiple circles, create/join preview, hub, detail, members, leave/edit/delete, shared timeline, and membership model are present.

F-010

Private Entry Sharing

Implemented

CloseCut/Features/Entries; CloseCut/Features/Social/Circle

Selected Circle sharing is explicit and private by default. Circle-side entry detail is read-only.

F-011

Reactions and Comments

Implemented

CloseCut/Core/Domain/Models/Circle; CloseCut/Features/Social

Circle reactions/comments and comment reporting are present; blocking and broader moderation remain limited.

F-012

Watch Together Plans

Implemented

CloseCut/Features/Social/WatchTogether; CloseCut/Core/Repositories/WatchPlanRepository.swift

Plans can originate from entries, Discover, saved titles, Battle winners, and Awards & Culture nominees.

F-013

Battle

Implemented

CloseCut/Features/Battle; CloseCut/Core/Repositories/BattleResultRepository.swift

Personal/local choice modes exist. Results are not remote multiplayer or posted to Circle spaces.

F-014

Awards and Culture

Implemented

CloseCut/Features/AwardsCulture

Local predictions and comparison with known results are present.

F-015

Insights and Wrap

Implemented

CloseCut/Features/Insights; CloseCut/Features/Wrap

Personal summaries and insight surfaces are implemented; they are not positioned as clinical or deterministic taste analysis.

F-016

Cinema Experience Intelligence

Partial

CloseCut/Core/Domain/Models/Entry/CinemaIntelligenceModels.swift; CloseCut/Features/Entries

Cinema context and experience fields exist. Longitudinal cinema insights and aggregated anonymous intelligence are future.

F-017

Notifications

Partial

CloseCut/Features/Notifications

Local notification surfaces exist. Push notifications and remote social activity delivery are not implemented.

F-018

Offline and Sync

Partial

CloseCut/Core/Sync; CloseCut/Core/Repositories

Local-first persistence, queue, conflict policy, push/pull, and manual/session sync exist. No real-time listeners, background sync, or automatic retry scheduler.

F-019

Profile and Account Controls

Partial

CloseCut/Features/Settings; CloseCut/Core/Services/AccountDeletionPreflightService.swift

Profile, privacy links, sync, language, appearance, sign out, and deletion preparation exist. Profile photo upload, complete account deletion, reset, and verification UI remain gaps.

F-020

Group QuickPick

Future

CloseCut/Features/Social/Circle

Circle-level recommendation remains placeholder/not implemented.

F-021

Real-time Collaboration

Future

Documentation/KNOWN_LIMITATIONS.md

No real-time Firestore listeners or true multiplayer Battle.

F-022

Taste DNA

Future

Historical PRDs

Strategic identity layer; not current product.

Appendix B - Product Truth Matrix

Claim

Current truth

Public-use rule

CloseCut is private by default

Supported by entry ownership and explicit Circle targets

Valid; avoid absolute security language

QuickPick is AI-powered

False for current product; engine is rule-based

Prohibited

CloseCut works offline

Core local history works locally; remote and social completion varies

Qualify as local-first, not “everything works offline”

Circles support multiple groups

Implemented through membership model

Valid after build QA

Circle recommendations exist

Group QuickPick is placeholder/not implemented

Prohibited as current claim

Realtime collaboration

Not implemented

Prohibited

Discover provides streaming availability

Not implemented

Prohibited

TestFlight is open

Current operational fact supplied by product owner

Valid while public link/build remains approved

Cinema intelligence exists

Capture models/fields exist; longitudinal intelligence is partial/future

Use “save cinema experience,” not broad intelligence claim

Account deletion is complete

Incomplete according to repository audits

Do not claim complete until verified

Appendix C - Terminology and Naming

CloseCut: product name; never translated.

Personal: owner-controlled private domain.

Timeline: temporal memory surface.

Library: searchable/filterable personal archive.

Quick Add: fast path for watched history.

QuickPick: focused personal recommendation experience.

Your List / Want to Watch: private future-intention list; choose one canonical UI label per locale.

Circle: named private membership context.

Watch Plan: Circle-scoped proposal to watch a specific title.

Battle: bounded choice mechanic; not competition among people.

Entry: one watched-memory record, lightweight or rich.

Shared: visible in selected Circle context; never synonymous with public.

Appendix D - Glossary

Approximate watched date: A user-supplied time label that may be less precise than a calendar date.

Candidate: A title considered by a decision tool but not necessarily saved or watched.

Local-first: Local state supports immediate product continuity; remote services synchronize or enrich.

Pending action: A locally recorded operation that has not completed remotely.

Rewatch candidate: A watched title intentionally resurfaced for another viewing.

Taste signal: A contextual input such as genre, mood, tag, sentiment, rating, save, dismissal, or rewatch behavior.

Appendix E - User Journey Maps

First Session

journey

title First meaningful CloseCut session

section Access

Create or enter account: 3: User

Understand private history promise: 4: User

section Activate

Choose Quick Add or Start Fresh: 4: User
Add several past watches: 5: User
See Timeline become personal: 5: User
section Explore
Complete one memory: 4: User
Try a focused decision tool: 4: User

Trusted Plan

graph LR
A[Candidate from Discover, List, Battle, or Entry] --> B[Select Circle]
B --> C[Create Watch Plan]
C --> D[Members respond]
D --> E[Plan closes]
E --> F[Owner records watched memory]

Appendix F - Core Loop Diagrams

graph LR
A[Watch] --> B[Remember]
B --> C[Reflect]
C --> D[Understand]
D --> E[Decide]
E --> A

Appendix G - Feature Dependency Map

graph TD
Auth --> Onboarding
Onboarding --> Entries
Entries --> Timeline
Entries --> QuickPick
Search --> QuickAdd
TMDB --> Search
Discover --> Watchlist
Watchlist --> Battle
Watchlist --> Entries
Circles --> Sharing
Sharing --> Reactions
Sharing --> Comments
Circles --> WatchPlans
QuickPick --> Watchlist

QuickPick --> WatchPlans

Sync --> Entries

Sync --> Watchlist

Sync --> Circles

Appendix H - Privacy Decision Matrix

Action

Default

User confirmation

Circle context required

Reversible

Create entry

Private

No

No

Yes

Share entry

Not shared

Yes

Yes

Yes

Save candidate

Private

User action

No

Yes

Create Watch Plan

Not created

Yes

Yes

Yes/close

Comment/react

None

User action

Yes

Yes where supported

Delete account

No

Strong confirmation

No

Subject to verified lifecycle

Appendix I

-

Recommen

dation

Decision

Matrix

Context

Allowed signals

Excluded signals

Current status

Personal QuickPick

User-owned history, metadata, moods, tags, sentiment, rating, rewatch, session history

Other users' private data

Implemented

Discover personalization

Local genre affinity and TMDB catalog data

Private Circle content unless explicitly designed

Implemented

Circle Group QuickPick

Only Circle-shared signals and explicit group context

Members' private-only history

Future

Battle

Explicit candidate set and user choices

Hidden global ranking

Implemented locally

Appendix J - Product Decision Records

PDR-001 - Private by Default

Decision: All personal records remain private unless the owner deliberately selects a Circle.

Rationale: Trust is a prerequisite for honest reflection.

Rejected: Public-by-default, account-wide sharing defaults.

Status: Current and permanent

PDR-002 - Memory over Ratings

Decision: The product prioritizes context, mood, notes, and personal meaning over public numerical scoring.

Rationale: A number is useful metadata but an incomplete memory.

Rejected: Star-first interaction model.

Status: Current and permanent

PDR-003 - Personal First, Social Second

Decision: Personal history must deliver value without Circle participation.

Rationale: The private archive is the product foundation; social value is additive.

Rejected: Social onboarding gate, public feed.

Status: Current and permanent

PDR-004 - One Thoughtful Pick

Decision: QuickPick presents a focused recommendation with a reason rather than an endless recommendation feed.

Rationale: Focus reduces decision fatigue and preserves agency.

Rejected: Infinite algorithmic feed.

Status: Current

PDR-005 - Local-First Trust

Decision: Core creation and reading experiences render from local state; remote services add synchronization and enrichment.

Rationale: Journal moments must not depend on perfect connectivity.

Rejected: Firestore-driven UI.

Status: Current and permanent

PDR-006 - Membership-Based Circles

Decision: Circle access is based on membership records, not a single profile circle ID.

Rationale: People belong to several trusted contexts.

Rejected: Single active Circle model.

Status: Current

PDR-007 - One Entry Model

Decision: Quick Add and rich journal records are states of one history object.

Rationale: A fast start must be able to deepen without migration friction.

Rejected: Separate quick-add database.

Status: Current

PDR-008 - Explain Recommendations

Decision: Every product recommendation needs a human-readable reason and bounded confidence.

Rationale: Explainability supports trust and correction.

Rejected: Opaque certainty claims.

Status: Current

PDR-009 - Explicit Circle Context

Decision: Shared content, plans, comments, and reactions are always attached to a named Circle.

Rationale: Context prevents accidental social leakage.

Rejected: Global friend feed.

Status: Current

PDR-010 - Calm, Native Interaction

Decision: CloseCut uses restrained, native-feeling interaction patterns and avoids engagement mechanics.

Rationale: The product is a reflective tool, not an attention market.

Rejected: Streaks, viral prompts, aggressive badges.

Status: Current and permanent

Appendix K - Deferred Concepts

Group QuickPick.

Taste DNA and compatibility.

Shared Memories.

Real-time Circle collaboration and remote multiplayer Battle.

Streaming-provider availability and playback integration.

Anonymous aggregate cinema intelligence.

Cross-platform parity.

Optional assisted insight generation.

Rich member administration and ownership transfer.

Appendix L - Historical Evolution

Era

Product center

Durable contribution

Superseded assumption

Discovery PRD

Private emotional journal

Mood, memory, privacy, Circle intimacy

Journal as the complete product

Activation-first v2

History and QuickPick

Quick Add, Timeline as identity, first-session value

New Entry as only activation path

Multi-Circle v3

Membership-based social context

Personal/social separation, selected Circle sharing

Single profile Circle

Current TestFlight

Broad memory and decision ecosystem

Discover, Watchlist, Battle, Plans, insights, operational release work

Six-screen and narrow MVP assumptions

Canonical v1

Private entertainment memory system

One product model, evidence statuses, governance

Historical docs as active source of truth

Appendix M - Document Changelog

Version 1.0 - 13 July 2026

Established canonical positioning, pillars, mental model, product rules, current scope, roadmap framework, and governance.

Reconciled historical PRDs, design specifications, programming guides, repository audits, known limitations, current source tree, and TestFlight status.

Added feature and product truth matrices.

Added decision records PDR-001 through PDR-010.

Separated current, partial, future, and obsolete concepts.